

شعر سے ملاقات

URDU FOR POETRY LOVERS

VOLUME 10 • THE ANNOTATED ANTHOLOGY

classical ghazal • modern voices • qawwali • cinema
24 guided encounters • clickable YouTube listening pathways

Prepared for

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The Anthology as a Practice

Volume 10 gathers the skills of the preceding books into one repeatable encounter with poetry. It is selective rather than encyclopaedic: each text has been chosen because it teaches a transferable way of reading—ambiguity, image, address, refrain, ethical turn, musical expansion or cultural afterlife.

Copyright and scope • Classical public-domain lines are quoted for close study. Modern poetry and film lyrics appear only as brief learning excerpts; use the listening links to encounter the complete authorised performance.

- 1 • **Hear** • Listen once without pausing; record image, mood and one recurring sound.
- 2 • **Read** • Move from Urdu to Roman only when the script blocks recognition.
- 3 • **Parse** • Locate the grammatical hinge: denial, address, comparison, question or reversal.
- 4 • **Layer** • Separate literal scene, emotional situation, symbolic field and philosophical claim.
- 5 • **Compare** • Hear a second rendition and compare choices—not celebrity.
- 6 • **Recite** • Speak the line plainly, then with metre and finally with restrained tarannum.
- 7 • **Keep** • Copy one line and write why it deserves a place in your personal anthology.

Listening Links: How to Use Them

Each workshop contains a clickable YouTube search link built from the poem and a suitable artist or tradition. Search links are used deliberately: they remain useful when channels rename, regional availability changes, or one upload disappears. Prefer official artist, label, broadcaster, archive or cultural-institution channels; compare the title and poet before trusting subtitles.

First hearing • Do not read subtitles. Mark voice, pace, return and emotional temperature.

Second hearing • Follow the printed line and circle words expanded or repeated.

Third hearing • Use subtitles cautiously; test them against your vocabulary.

Version note • Record singer, channel, duration, date accessed, and whether the text is complete or selected.

Safety against false lyrics • If two uploads disagree, consult a reputable printed divan or poetry archive before memorising.

Map of Volume 10

PART	FOCUS	CONTENTS
I	Twelve classical shers	Mir, Ghalib, Momin, Zafar, Dagh, Hasrat and Iqbal
II	Six modern encounters	Faiz, Firaq, Sahir and Gulzar
III	Six qawwali/Sufi encounters	Khusrau, Bulleh Shah, Kabir tradition and Aziz Mian
IV	Comparative laboratories	One text, two voices; page, stage and screen
V	Capstone practice	Twelve-week anthology and listening programme

Part I • The Classical Treasury

Twelve shers that reward repeated reading. Treat the English as a floor, not a ceiling.

Classical 1 • Mir • The beloved as presence

پتا پتا بوٹا بوٹا حال ہمارا جانے ہے

patta patta boota boota haal hamaara jaane hai

Plain sense • Every leaf and every plant knows my condition.

Why the line matters • The lover's secret is paradoxically public: nature knows what the beloved does not acknowledge.

Language keys • patta leaf • boota plant • haal condition • jaane knows

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 2 • Mir • The heart as habitation

دل کی ویرانی کا کیا مذکور ہے

dil ki veeraani ka kya mazkoor hai

Plain sense • What can one even say of the heart's desolation?

Why the line matters • The rhetorical question does not seek information. It enlarges ruin beyond adequate speech.

Language keys • veeraani desolation • mazkoor mention

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 3 • Ghalib • Desire without exhaustion

ہزاروں خواہشیں ایسی کہ ہر خواہش پہ دم نکلے

hazaaron khwaahishen aisi ki har khwaahish pe dam nikle

Plain sense • Thousands of desires—each one intense enough to take my breath.

Why the line matters • Hyperbole becomes psychology: fulfilment cannot cure desire because desire multiplies faster than experience.

Language keys • khwaahish desire • dam breath/life • nikle depart

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 4 • Ghalib • The difficult made ordinary

بس کہ دشوار ہے ہر کام کا آسان ہونا

bas ki dushvaar hai har kaam ka aasaan hona

Plain sense • So difficult it is for any task to become easy.

Why the line matters • The balanced opposites dushvaar/aasan give philosophical wit the compactness of a proverb.

Language keys • dushvaar difficult • aasaan easy • kaam task

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 5 • Ghalib • Being human

آدمی کو بھی میسر نہیں انساں ہونا

aadmi ko bhi mayassar nahin insaan hona

Plain sense • Even a human being does not easily attain true humanity.

Why the line matters • Aadmi names the biological/social person; insaan becomes an ethical achievement.

Language keys • mayassar available/attainable • insaan humane person

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 6 • Momin • Intimacy and secrecy

تم میرے پاس ہوتے ہو گویا جب کوئی دوسرا نہیں ہوتا

tum mere paas hote ho goya jab koi doosra nahin hota

Plain sense • You seem to be beside me when no one else is present.

Why the line matters • Goya suspends certainty: is this memory, inward presence, imagination, or a confession possible only in solitude?

Language keys • paas near • goya as though • doosra another

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 7 • Zafar • Exile within desire

لگتا نہیں ہے دل مرا اجڑے دیار میں

lagta nahin hai dil mera ujre dayaar mein

Plain sense • My heart cannot settle in this ravaged land.

Why the line matters • The idiom dil lagna means both taking interest and finding belonging; exile breaks both.

Language keys • ujra ruined • dayaar homeland/abode • dil lagna to feel at home

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 8 • Zafar • The unfulfilled life

عمر دراز مانگ کے لائے تھے چار دن

umr-e-daraaz maang ke laaye the chaar din

Plain sense • I asked for a long life and received four days.

Why the line matters • The exact small number turns metaphysical disappointment into dry, memorable irony.

Language keys • umr-e-daraaz long life • maang asked • chaar four

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 9 • Dagħ • The economy of love

خوب پردہ ہے کہ چلمن سے لگے بیٹھے ہیں

khoob parda hai ki chilman se lage baithe hain

Plain sense • What fine concealment—sitting pressed against the screen.

Why the line matters • Praise becomes teasing accusation: concealment itself reveals presence and invites attention.

Language keys • parda veil • chilman screen • lage baithe positioned close

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 10 • Hasrat • Love as a force

چپکے چپکے رات دن آنسو بہانا یاد ہے

chupke chupke raat din aansoo bahaana yaad hai

Plain sense • I remember silently shedding tears, night and day.

Why the line matters • Soft repetition makes secrecy audible; yaad hai converts pain into an act of tender recollection.

Language keys • chupke secretly • aansoo tears • bahaana to shed • yaad memory

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 11 • Iqbal • Selfhood and destiny

خودی کو کر بلند اتنا کہ ہر تقدیر سے پہلے

khudi ko kar buland itna ki har taqdeer se pehle

Plain sense • Raise the self so high that, before every decree—

Why the line matters • Khudi is not mere ego; it is cultivated moral-spiritual agency. The unfinished syntax pushes us into the answering line.

Language keys • khudi selfhood • buland elevated • taqdeer destiny

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Classical 12 • Iqbal • The answer to destiny

خدا بندے سے خود پوچھے بتا تیری رضا کیا ہے

khuda bande se khud poochhe bata teri raza kya hai

Plain sense • God asks the servant: tell me, what is your will?

Why the line matters • The theological shock lies in reversed address: disciplined selfhood becomes worthy of consultation.

Language keys • banda servant/person • poochhe asks • raza will/consent

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Part II • Modern Poetry and Cinema

These brief excerpts are doorways. Hear the complete work and attend to the movement beyond the quoted line.

Modern 1 • Faiz • Hope under oppression

گلوں میں رنگ بھرے بادِ نو بہار چلے

gulon mein rang bhare baad-e-nau-bahaar chale

Plain sense • May the new spring breeze fill the flowers with colour.

Why the line matters • A traditional garden opening can hold private longing and public renewal at once.

Listening focus • Listen for how a singer keeps beauty from becoming merely decorative.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Modern 2 • Faiz • The beloved and the world

مجھ سے پہلی سی محبت مرے محبوب نہ مانگ

mujh se pehli si mohabbat mere mahboob na maang

Plain sense • Do not ask of me the love I once gave you.

Why the line matters • The poem does not reject love; it refuses a love that excludes suffering beyond the lovers.

Listening focus • Track the turn from singular beloved to the wounded social body.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Modern 3 • Faiz • Public speech

بول کہ لب آزاد ہیں تیرے

bol ki lab aazaad hain tere

Plain sense • Speak, for your lips are free.

Why the line matters • Imperative grammar turns lyric voice into ethical summons without surrendering musicality.

Listening focus • Notice whether performance sounds intimate, collective, defiant, or ceremonial.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Modern 4 • Firaq • Night and inward weather

رات بھی نیند بھی کہانی بھی

raat bhi neend bhi kahaani bhi

Plain sense • Night, sleep, and story too.

Why the line matters • The repeated bhi makes a chain of presences; grammar is minimal, atmosphere maximal.

Listening focus • Hear how pauses create relationships the sentence leaves unstated.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Modern 5 • Sahir • Romance questioned

کبھی کبھی مرے دل میں خیال آتا ہے

kabhi kabhi mere dil mein khayaal aata hai

Plain sense • Sometimes a thought comes into my heart.

Why the line matters • The familiar opening is powerful because it makes reverie intermittent, private, and almost involuntary.

Listening focus • Compare recitation with the film-song setting; note what cinema makes concrete.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Modern 6 • Gulzar • Image before explanation

دل ڈھونڈتا ہے پھر وہی فرصت کے رات دن

dil dhoondta hai phir wahi fursat ke raat din

Plain sense • The heart seeks again those leisurely days and nights.

Why the line matters • An old poetic idiom enters modern memory through domestic weather, time, and tactile detail.

Listening focus • Listen for nostalgia created by pacing rather than vocal display.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Part III • Qawwali and Sufi Poetry

Read the line, but also study what repetition, response, interpolation and gathering do to it.

Qawwali 1 • Amir Khusrau • Colour and initiation

آج رنگ ہے اے ماں رنگ ہے ری

aaj rang hai ae maan rang hai ri

Plain sense • Today there is colour, mother—colour everywhere.

Why the line matters • Rang is colour, joy, transformation, and the trace of the spiritual guide. Refrain makes the state communal.

Listening focus • Count each return and name what has changed around it.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Qawwali 2 • Amir Khusrau • The gaze

چھاپ تلک سب چھینی رے موسے نیناں ملائیے

chhaap tilak sab chheeni re mose naina milaike

Plain sense • You took away all my marks of identity merely by meeting my eyes.

Why the line matters • Love dissolves social identity through the smallest encounter: a glance.

Listening focus • Hear how Hindavi intimacy and repetition intensify surrender.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Qawwali 3 • Traditional • The saint as refuge

بھردو جھولی میری یا محمد

bhar do jholi meri ya Muhammad

Plain sense • Fill my begging cloth, O Muhammad.

Why the line matters • The concrete jholi makes dependence visible; repetition moves petition toward trust.

Listening focus • Distinguish supplication, praise, and performance climax.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Qawwali 4 • Bulleh Shah • Identity stripped away

بلہا کی جاناں میں کون

bulleh ki jaana main kaun

Plain sense • Bulleh, how should I know who I am?

Why the line matters • Negation becomes a spiritual method: inherited categories fall away before a final definition arrives.

Listening focus • Do not force the Punjabi into Urdu; listen for cognates and repeated negations.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Qawwali 5 • Kabir tradition • Beyond ritual labels

من لاگو یار فقیری میں

man laago yaar faqiri mein

Plain sense • Friend, my heart has become attached to the life of spiritual poverty.

Why the line matters • Faqiri reverses worldly value: lack becomes freedom and inward wealth.

Listening focus • Compare folk, bhajan, and qawwali-inflected treatments.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Qawwali 6 • Aziz Mian • Devotional argument

میں شرابی

main sharaabi

Plain sense • I am intoxicated.

Why the line matters • Wine vocabulary may stage ecstatic love, defiance, confession, or theological argument—not simply literal drinking.

Listening focus • Track who is being addressed and how each inserted verse changes the defence.

LISTEN • [Open a focused YouTube search](#)

Three-pass task • 1) Hear without subtitles. 2) Follow the Urdu and mark the hinge. 3) Recite, then write one alternative interpretation supported by a word or performance choice.

Notebook prompt • What remains deliberately unresolved? Name the exact word, image, pause or repetition that protects the ambiguity.

Comparative Laboratory 1 • One Ghazal, Two Voices

Choose Chupke Chupke Raat Din or Gulon Mein Rang Bhare in two contrasting renditions. The task is architectural comparison, not ranking.

Text selection • Which shers are included, omitted or reordered?

Opening • Speech-like, melodic, instrumental or immediate refrain?

Diction • Which consonants and izafat links remain clearest?

Time • Which line receives the longest dwelling?

Return • What becomes the emotional home point?

Closure • Poetic resolution, musical cadence, signature sher or applause point?

[YouTube: compare Chupke Chupke renditions](#)

Comparative Laboratory 2 • Page, Voice and Screen

Use Kabhi Kabhie Mere Dil Mein or Dil Dhoondta Hai. Read the excerpt first, hear an audio-only rendition second, then watch the film sequence. Ask what each medium adds and what it closes down.

Page • Which beloved, season, room or speaker did you imagine?

Voice • How did melody shape time, intimacy and certainty?

Screen • Which ambiguity became a character, location or flashback?

Judgment • Did cinema deepen the poem or merely specify it? Cite one concrete choice.

[YouTube: film-poetry comparison](#)

Comparative Laboratory 3 • Refrain Under Pressure

Choose Aaj Rang Hai or Chaap Tilak. Track six returns of the refrain. For every return, note the preceding line, lead voice, chorus response, tempo, density and emotional verb.

RETURN	PRECEDING IDEA	VOICE	SOUND CHANGE	NEW VERB
1	_____	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____	_____
4	_____	_____	_____	_____
5	_____	_____	_____	_____
6	_____	_____	_____	_____

[YouTube: Aaj Rang performance search](#)

Your Twelve-Week Capstone Anthology

WEEK	WORLD	OUTPUT
1-2	Mir and Ghalib	four classical shers; literal and symbolic readings
3-4	Other classical voices	Momin, Zafar, Dagħ, Hasrat and Iqbal
5-6	Faiz and modernity	love, public speech and social turn
7	Film poetry	page-voice-screen comparison
8-9	Khusrau traditions	rang, gaze, multilingual intimacy and refrain
10	Vernacular Sufi poetry	Bulleh Shah and Kabir pathways
11	Performance comparison	two versions of one text
12	Independent curation	ten-item personal anthology with spoken introduction

Completion standard • You can introduce ten selections without notes, recite at least five accurately, explain one ambiguity in each, and compare two performances using audible evidence.

Personal Anthology Record

Text identity • Title/opening words • poet • form • language • source

My line • Urdu • Roman • literal sense

The hinge • The word, syntax or image on which meaning turns

Two readings • A personal/emotional reading and a symbolic/social/philosophical reading

Performance • Artist • channel • link • duration • date accessed

Audible evidence • Pause, stress, repetition, melody, insertion, audience or closure

Why I keep it • A three-sentence personal note, without pretending to know the poet's intention

Closing: From Translation to Companionship

At the beginning of this series, an Urdu poem could feel like a beautiful locked room. Vocabulary supplied keys; script opened the door; grammar revealed movement; metre and image taught attention; qawwali and song returned poetry to breath, gathering and time. The goal of Volume 10 is not to finish Urdu. It is to make the poem a companion you can revisit with greater hearing each time.

لفظ سے معنی، معنی سے کیفیت، کیفیت سے صحبت

From word to meaning, from meaning to felt state, from felt state to companionship.

A possible Volume 11 • Writing and recitation studio: composing the sher, building radif and qafiyah, translating without flattening, and recording a personal poetry portfolio.